of the fact that whatever creative or progressive role the British **might** have played in the past in India, they had long ceased to **play** it, **and** were now a hindrance and an obstruction to all progress. The tempo of their official life was slow and incapable of solving **any** of the vital problems before India. Even their utterances, which used to have some clarity and strength, became turgid, inept, and lacking any real content.

There has long been a legend, propagated by British authorities, that the British Government, through its higher services in India, was training us for the difficult and intricate art of self-government. VVe had managed to carry on, and with a considerable degree of success, for a few thousand years before the British came here and gave us the advantage of their training.

No doubt we lack many of the good qualities that we should possess, and some misguided persons e.ven say that this deficiency has grown under British rule. But whatever our failings might be, it seemed obvious to us that the permanent services here were totally incapable of leading India in any progressive direction. The very qualities they possessed made them unhelpful, for the qualities necessary in a police state are utterly different